

A MENTAL MODEL IN ONE PAGE

# The folder is the app. It runs on your machine. *It belongs to you.*

You don't need a platform. You don't need an account. You need **three tools you already use** - pointed at the same folder on your machine. That folder, and what's inside it, **is your app**.

01 THE INGREDIENTS



i.

### The editor

WHERE YOU WORK · FREE

An open code editor of your choice - these are usually free. It shows the files and lets you edit, search, and talk to your chosen assistant in normal language. Nothing magical, just the workshop bench.



ii.

### The assistant

THE INTELLIGENCE · ~\$20/MO

An AI assistant that reads your folder, follows your written instructions, edits files, and runs scripts on your behalf. Use a **paid version** (e.g. Claude at about \$20/month) - that's what keeps the work fully secure.



iii.

### Your filesystem

WHAT YOU ALREADY OWN

Plain folders, plain files - on the computer you already own. No cloud, no database, no proprietary format. Just the same disk you've been using for years. The thing that makes it yours.

point all three at the same folder ↓

02 THE OUTPUT - A FOLDER ON DISK

~/Praxis/folder

▼

folder/

your project

—

SKILL.md

the rules · written in plain English

—

run.py

the script · the work it does

—

documents/

your data · the inputs

—

output/

what gets produced

4 items · ~12 KB

opens in any editor · runs anywhere

- A

**SKILL.md**

The instructions you'd give a new hire on day one - written once, in plain language. The assistant reads this every time and follows it. Change the file, change the behavior.
- B

**run.py**

A short script that does the actual work - pulls data, transforms a document, sends an email. The assistant writes it with you and runs it for you.
- C

**documents/**

Whatever the work needs to chew on - PDFs, spreadsheets, transcripts, contracts. Drop files in. Pull files out. No upload step.
- D

**Version control, optional**

Because it's a folder, the standard tools just work - git, Time Machine, Dropbox, a USB stick. There's nothing special to back up.